During the last few days of my stay in Tehran once I went to your place at Golhak and twice to your house in the Town, to see you and your family in order to give you my blessings and bid you farewell, but I am sorry I was disappointed in not having the pleasure of seeing you, for I have to assure by these few lines that the friendship you showed me and the trouble you took for me during my stay in Tehran are always in my mind and shall be remembered to the last breath of my life. May the Almighty keep your family and your good self many many years in the enjoyment of perfect health and happiness which is always my ardent wish and prayer.

I shall be much obliged by your sending to me a few copies of the Persian paper of Tehran, containing the notification about my affairs at the Court of Persia which was published a few months previous to the last Notification about the same, for the latter I have got a few copies but none of the former.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, December 21, 1854*

Persia is still neutral in the war which rages between Russia and the European powers[133] and I hope she will continue so. Russia has bid fair, for the assistance of Persia, against the Turks, but did not bid quite enough; Persia had great grounds of complaint against Turkey, and an army of fifty or sixty thousand Persians on the Turkish frontier, would have been a powerful diversion in favor of Russia: however Persia has remained quiet; and I am very glad she has done so; as any other course must have been most ruinous to her, except she had joined the allies against Russia; now, much depends upon the fall of Sebastepol for should that place hold out much longer, it is possible, but still very improbable that Persia may still be drawn into a Russian alliance. The Persians and Turks hate one another as the English and French did formerly; and it has required all the British influence and all the skill of Mr Thomson, our Chargé d'affaires to keep them quiet. My position would be a strange one, if Persia were to make war on Turkey, for it would at the present moment be the same thing as making war upon England, for although my employment is altogether civil, yet how could I continue in the service of a state which was at war with my own country.

We have had a great rise in the price of grain here, and barley the chief food of our horses which is usually at about S12/ a quater is now at 28/ this is partly to be attributed to a want of rain last season, and blight in some of the corn districts. The Govt have also made the matter worse by trying to force people to sell at a certain price, in which they have not succeeded, bread also was ordered to be sold at a certain price and the consequence has been that some days the

133 The Crimean War.

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